

MINI PROJECTORS

Good For Road Warriors and Nuclear Families

If portability is high on your mind and you need to present to a small audience group, get a mini projector for yourself!

■ UMA BANSAL

Though mini projectors have evolved very recently, these have already started creating their own market. These pocket-size devices do away with the bulkiness and heaviness of conventional projectors, and allow you to give presentations on the go and watch movies from a USB with ease. They are portable in true sense, and many of them use the same adaptor as a notebook's.

These compact projectors come in various sizes, brightness, contrast ratio, connectivity options and convenience features. Some even free you from carrying your laptop along to make presentations.

However, because of their compactness, mini projectors come at a little price premium over regular projectors. Also, visual excellence is compromised as these generally have less brightness and contrast ratio.

Nevertheless, if portability is high on your mind, why wait? Get set to grab one.

Classification based on weight

Based on weight, projectors can be classified as follows:

- Pico: Quarter kg or less
- Nano-portable (palm): Up to 1 kg
- Micro portable: Up to 2.5 kg
- Ultra portable: Up to 5 kg
- Conventional: Above 5 kg

Of these, pico and palm projectors come under mini category.

Pico projectors are the size of a mobile phone but have a brightness of 10-30 ANSI lumens only (requiring complete darkness in the room) and give a very small screen size between 25.4 and 51 cm (10 and 20 inches). So these are suitable only for small-size projection.

Palm projectors, in comparison, have a brightness of as much as 200-300 ANSI lumens and give a screen size between 102 and 305 cm (40 and 120 inches). This makes them suitable for presentation and watching movies. LG HS201G and HX301G weigh about 800 gm each.

So if you want the convenience of a highly portable

projector and a screen size of minimum 102 cm (40 inches), a palm projector is a good choice.

Moving to a bit heavier category, NEC's micro projectors weigh 1.7 kg but can project data from a USB memory device—a big advantage. These produce a brightness of 2300 lumens XGA to 3000 ANSI lumens XGA, and have inbuilt auto-focus and shutter for the lens. If you have to receive a phone call amid a home movie or presenta-



tion, just slide the cover of the lens to stop the audio and video. The series includes four models.

Ideal users

Mini projectors are best suited for roaming professionals as these are so thin, lightweight and compact that they can be easily accommodated in a